

STEVEN “Steve” ARCHULETA

Data Science & Machine Learning | Financial Engineering & Risk Analytics | MLOps | Generative AI / NLP

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Santa Rosa, CA | U.S. & Portuguese citizenships; USA & EU eligibility | Open to remote, hybrid, or full relocation

SUMMARY

Master of Science in Financial Engineering (WorldQuant University, June 2026; coursework average 91%, capstone 96%). Combines applied machine learning, quantitative finance, and generative AI skills. Proficient in Python-based data science and ML workflows — from EDA and feature engineering through model training, evaluation, and MLOps deployment. Ranked #1 of 30 peers in Generative AI for NLP; ranked top 20% in the UT Austin AI & ML postgraduate program 3.92 GPA. Seeking roles in data science, AI/ML engineering, quantitative research, financial engineering, and/or risk analytics. Nonlinear career spanning NIH biomedical research, California State IT, STEM teaching, and eight years of multi-store retail entrepreneurship directing 21 employees. Strong communicator and proven leader across technical, academic, entrepreneurial and cross-functional environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming & Data: Python (Pandas, NumPy, SciPy, scikit-learn, statsmodels, TensorFlow/Keras, XGBoost, LangChain, Streamlit), SQL (MySQL, T-SQL), MLflow, FAISS, Excel, Git/GitHub

Machine Learning / Deep Learning: Regression, classification, Random Forest, XGBoost, gradient boosting, ANN, CNN, LSTM, time-series forecasting, cross-validation, hyperparameter tuning, error analysis

Finance / Risk / Quantitative: Portfolio analytics, VaR/CVaR, volatility forecasting, risk targeting, factor modeling, causal-aware modeling, Directed Acyclic Graph modeling, derivative pricing, stochastic modeling, econometrics, walk-forward backtesting

Generative AI / NLP: LangChain agents, RAG pipelines, OpenAI API, Azure OpenAI, embeddings, prompt engineering (system prompts, few-shot, structured reasoning workflows), structured outputs, grounding evaluation, hallucination detection, GRPO/RLHF concepts.

Platforms & Tools: Jupyter, VS Code, Azure ML Studio, Azure Container Apps, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Conda, Docker basics, pytest, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Power BI, Tableau

Web Development: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, React, Node.js, Express, MongoDB

FEATURED PROJECTS

RiskML Capstone — Causal-Aware Risk Forecasting & Factor Construction | WorldQuant University | 2026

- End-to-end ML-driven risk-forecasting pipeline integrating 458,662 NLP-derived sentiment signals, a 9-node directed acyclic graph (DAG), DAG-informed XGBoost and LSTM forecasting models, and a 7-model portfolio backtest across 2,798 trading days; capstone score 96%.
- Deployed Streamlit dashboard to Azure Container Apps with OIDC-based CI/CD; modular six-subpackage Python architecture (etl, features, models, causal, portfolio, backtest).

[GitHub Repo](#) · [Live Dashboard](#) · [Video Walkthrough](#)

LLM Data Science Assistant — RAG-Powered Analytics Agent | Great Learning | 2024–2026

- Built, then extended, a LangChain/OpenAI RAG assistant into a modular Azure MLOps data-science agent with deterministic EDA, plotting, statistics, ML, SQL, and FAISS retrieval tools; validated with GitHub Actions CI, Azure ML pipelines, OIDC authentication, and ACR image publishing.

Azure MLOps CI/CD Portfolio — Reproducible ML Pipelines | Personal & Academic | 2025–2026

- Built Python-based reproducible workflows across used-car pricing, medical-manual RAG retrieval, Auto MPG, machine-failure, and diabetes projects; implemented Azure ML data assets, reusable components, preprocessing pipelines, model training/evaluation, MLflow logging, model registration, FAISS indexing, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Docker, and versioned artifacts.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- IT Student Assistant** | California Dept. of Social Services | Sacramento, CA 2021–2024
- Authored a division-wide business-case report comparing AWS Connect vs. Verizon InContact, translating operational requirements into cost, scalability, and service-risk criteria; projected ~\$1.2M annual savings.
 - Managed internal/external web pages and Section 508/WCAG accessibility remediation; produced evaluation tables, charts, and executive-ready narratives for leadership.
- Owner / Operator** | The Good Life Market & The New General Store | Howard County, MD 2005–2013
- Founded, operated, and scaled three boutique retail stores; directed 21 employees across hiring, payroll, scheduling, performance management, and vendor negotiations; managed P&L, multi-store budgets, A/R, A/P, and contracts.
 - Applied exploratory data analysis on customer demographics, repeat-purchase behavior, and sell-through rates; achieved consistent 10% year-over-year sales growth. Featured in The Washington Post Magazine; recognized with Best of Baltimore (2 consecutive years).
- Science & Technology Teacher** | Saint Mary’s College High School / Howard County Schools | CA / MD 2000–2005
- Taught Chemistry, Biology, Technology Education, and Basic Drafting; developed lab-based curricula, issued final grades, and communicated complex scientific concepts to diverse learners.
- Biomedical Research Fellow** | National Institutes of Health (NHLBI) | Bethesda, MD 1998–2000
- Investigated bioprosthetic heart-valve pathology using immunohistochemical, fluorescence, confocal, and transmission electron microscopy techniques; co-authored two peer-reviewed articles in Circulation.
- Additional Concurrent Employment** | Friedman’s Home Improvement (Nursery) | Santa Rosa, CA | 2024–Present
- Part-time customer-service during the MScFE program and while building Azure ML / MLOps portfolio projects.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- M.Sc. Financial Engineering** | WorldQuant University | Graduated June 2026
- Coursework average 91%; capstone 96%.** Courses: Financial Econometrics (94%), Deep Learning for Finance (93%), Derivative Pricing (93%), Risk Management (92%), Financial Data (90%), Machine Learning in Finance (90%), Portfolio Management (88%), Financial Markets (86%), Stochastic Modeling (86%).
- B.A., Diversified Liberal Arts** | Saint Mary’s College of California · [Diploma](#)
- Reinforcement Learning for LLMs (GRPO)** | Ragpack.ai | 2026 · [Certificate](#)
- Microsoft AI Professional Program** | Great Learning | Azure AI, Azure ML Studio, Azure AI Foundry, CI/CD | 2025
- Generative AI for Natural Language Processing** | Great Learning | Ranked #1 of 30 peers | 2024 · [Verify](#)
- Post-Graduate Program — Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning** | UT Austin / McCombs School of Business | GPA 3.92, Ranked 35/176 | 2022 · [Verify](#)
- SQL & Database Architecture** | Great Learning | 2022 · [Verify](#)
- Advanced Data Analytics Immersive Fellowship (400 hrs)** | General Assembly | 2020 · [Certificate](#)
- MERN Full-Stack Web Development Boot Camp** | University of California, Davis | 2019 · [Verify](#)

PUBLICATIONS

- Co-authored in *Circulation* (American Heart Association):
1. *Laser Scanning Confocal Microscopy: An Emerging Technique for the Pathologic Evaluation of Cardiac Devices*
 2. *Polymeric Scaffold Tissue Engineered Heart Valves: Explant Pathology*

TARGET ROLES

Applied Data Scientist | Risk / Forecasting Analyst | Financial Engineering Analyst | GenAI / RAG Engineer